



FRIDAY

TODAY'S GIFT

Celebrate the Sabbath—a weekly gift from God filled with love, rest, joy, and time together.

MEMORY VERSE

Then God blessed the seventh day and sanctified it, because in it He rested from all His work which God had created and made. Gen 2:3 NKJV

INTRODUCTION

MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

Draw a large number 7 on a sheet of paper. Write the first part of the sentence along the top of the 7 and the second half of the sentence down the stem of the 7. Then, cover the words and say them from memory.



Sabbath: A Gift of Love

Sabbath is a gift of love from God to care for our spiritual, physical, emotional, and relational well-being. He knows we need to pause from our weekly routines and focus on His love. In His loving arms, we can reflect on the past week and notice how He has led us and loved us. We can pray about the week to come, give Him our worries and fears, and pray for the love and wisdom to help us through our challenges.

Sabbath is a day to care for our bodies, to rest from hard work, or to walk in nature if we have been sitting inside all week. It's a day to experience the positive emotions of heaven as we worship God: joy, love, peace, wonder, hope, inspiration, a sense of purpose, creativity, gratitude, and laughter. And it's a day to show love to others and alleviate their suffering. How will you share these beautiful gifts with your family?

DEVOTIONAL

God's Great Gift of Sabbath

It was Friday evening, and Daddy was ready to start worship. He had blown up a whole bag of balloons. There were two big red heart-shaped balloons and lots of other round balloons. Luke and Lara wondered what he would do with all the balloons in worship!

Daddy asked Luke and Lara to name all the activities that happened during the week: school, shopping, football, work, laundry, making dinner, cleaning, gardening, homework, going to work! The list was long. Each time they called out a word, Daddy wrote it on a different balloon with a permanent pen.

Soon, all the round balloons had big words written on them. "What about the heart-shaped balloons?" asked Lara. "What are

they for?" Daddy wrote "Loving God" on one heart-shaped balloon and "Loving other people" on the other balloon.

Lara and Luke stood in the middle of the room. Daddy said, "Now, you must work hard to keep all the balloons up in the air at once, and none of them are allowed to touch the floor!"

Luke and Lara started throwing the balloons in the air. There were so many balloons, and it was hard to stop them from falling on the floor. They ran around, hitting the balloons in the air as fast as possible. It was hard work, and soon, they were tired.

"Well done, Lara and Luke!" said Mommy. "It's hard work keeping all the balloons in the air! Working all week long is exhausting!"

"Now it's Sabbath!" said daddy. "You can let all the 'work' balloons drop on the floor and have a rest." Mommy gathered them up in a big garbage bag. The heart-shaped balloons were left on the floor. "Now just keep these two in the air."

Lara and Luke gently patted the two balloons. Keeping the two “love” balloons in the air was so restful and easy. Each time they tapped a balloon, they called out for kind and loving things to do on Sabbath.

“When Adam and Eve woke up after their first night’s sleep, God had a special gift waiting for the world! Can you guess what it was?”

“Was it the continuation of Sabbath?” wondered Luke. “Yes! Sabbath is like an every-week birthday gift for the world! It’s a love gift from God from sunset Friday to sunset Saturday!” Mommy smiled.

“God wasn’t tired, and Adam and Eve hadn’t worked at all. But God wanted them to have the special gift one day every week to spend with Him, learning about love and creation, and caring for each other,” explained Daddy.

Mommy handed Luke and Lara a big gift box. “Here’s a present to remind you of the special gifts that God packed into Sabbath for us to enjoy.” Inside was a beautiful Bible storybook, a backpack of things for exploring nature, beautiful cards to take to lonely people and others in need, and a fun Bible game to play together. They smiled. Sabbath was a wonderful every-week birthday gift for the world!



PRAYING TOGETHER **Sabbath Blessing**

- In some Jewish traditions, each family lights candles on Friday evenings and prays blessings over each other.
- Gather one candle for each person in the family. Light the candles safely.
- Tell each person in your family one way in which they have blessed you in the past week.
- Pray a blessing over each person and ask God to bless their Sabbath rest with love, peace, and joy.

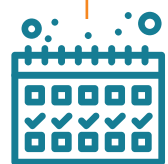


Family Activities



Sabbath Gifts

- Find a small gift box or container.
- Have each person choose three small items that remind them of the Sabbath. Ideas: a battery (Sabbath recharges us), a heart (God's love), hand lotion (comfort), a seed (new beginnings), or a treat (joy).
- Put all the items in the box and talk about why each was chosen.
- Place the box on your table as a Sabbath reminder.



Seven Days in a Row

- Look around your home for seven objects that represent something from each day of the past week.
- Pick one item for Sunday through Friday and something special for Sabbath.
- Line them up in order to tell your week's story.
- Share how you saw God's love each day.



Sabbath Manna

- Gather paper plates (or cut paper circles), pens, and snacks like popcorn, nuts, or dried fruit.
- Read Exodus 16:1–31 about manna.
- Divide the plate into seven sections, one for each day.
- Place one snack for Sunday through Thursday, two for Friday, none for Sabbath.
- Act out each day by eating, moving, then resting. On Sabbath, eat Friday's extra portion and sing a praise song!

FRIDAY AT A GLANCE

THE VERSE

Then God blessed the seventh day and sanctified it, because in it He rested from all His work which God had created and made. Gen 2:3 NKJV

THE INTRODUCTION

Sabbath is God's special gift for rest, joy, and love.

THE DEVOTIONAL

God invites us to pause from work, enjoy His creation, and focus on loving Him and others.

THE PRAYER

Thank You, Lord, for the Sabbath—a day to rest and love.

THE CONVERSATION

How will you celebrate God's Sabbath gift this week?